



Hyden Rock

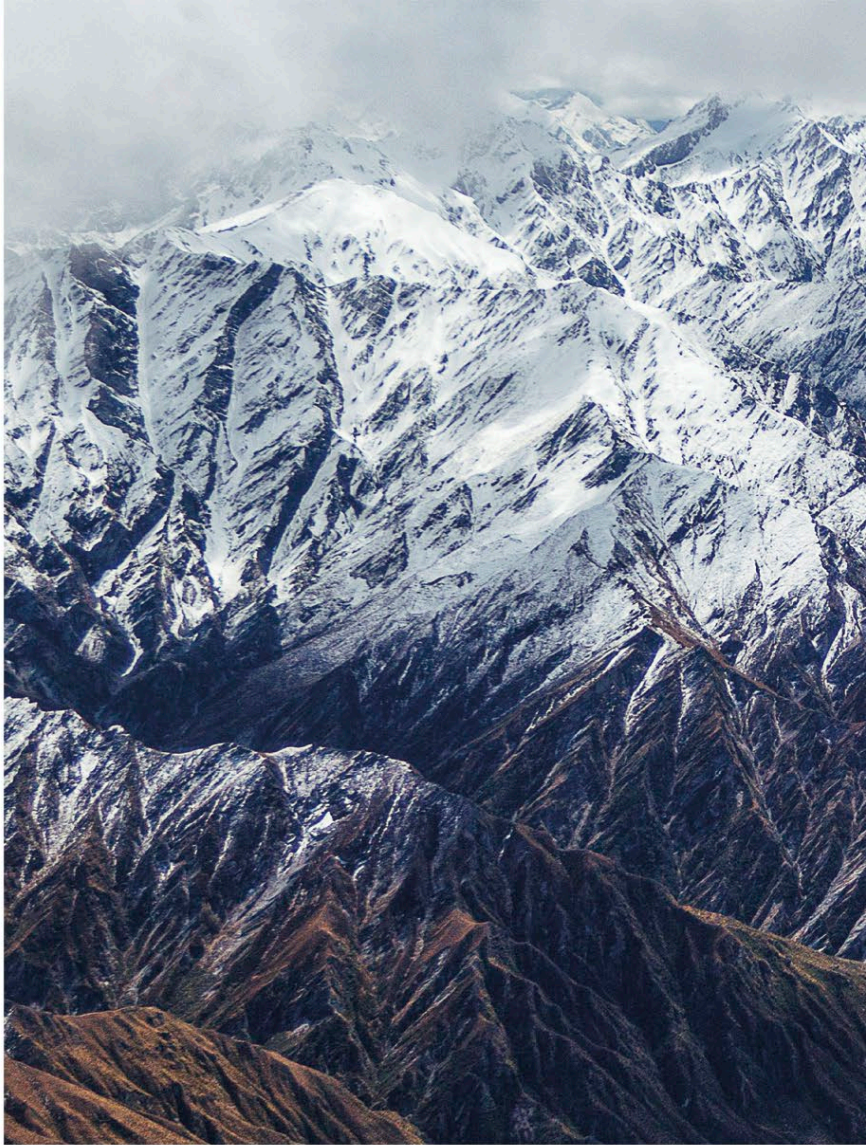
An ancient granite mound in Western Australia, with a wavelike cliff on one side of its base

Hyden Rock is famous for an unusual rock formation, which looks like a tall, breaking ocean wave, along a section of its base. Known as Wave Rock, it is thought to have been created by weathering and erosion of the base of the mound. The initial stage of weathering took place underground through slightly acidic groundwater breaking down the granite. This produced a concave pocket of fragmented granite within the formerly solid base. When the land surface around Hyden Rock was later lowered by erosion, the pocket of fragmented granite was also removed, leaving behind Wave Rock. Crystals from it have been dated at 2.7 billion years old, making it one of the oldest formations in Australia.



◁ **WAVE ROCK**
The formation is around 360 ft (110 m) long and 46 ft (14 m) high. The gray and amber stripes are the result of rainwater dissolving out minerals.

▽ **SMOOTH FORMATION**
The wave illusion is largely the result of the rounded overhang. Above the overhang, the rock's top surface is smooth and domed.



◁ **ICY HEIGHTS**
Aoraki, or Mount Cook, is exceptionally challenging to climb. The surrounding area is an extensive, high crevassed ice-field from which several major glaciers descend.

